

Muratbyek (Mark) Ablai

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Education

Bachelor of Science in Information Technology, Emphasis in Cybersecurity December 2026
Minor in Mathematics
Missouri State University, Springfield MO GPA: 3.94/4.00
Outstanding Student in Cybersecurity, College of Business April 2026

Certifications & Technical Skills

CompTIA Security+ July 2026
CompTIA Network+ June 2026

Networking: Cisco IOS, OSPF, Palo Alto (PAN-OS), FortiGate, VLANs, DNS (BIND 9), DHCP, VPN, NAT
Systems: Linux (Debian, Ubuntu), Proxmox VE, Windows Server, Active Directory, Apache2, MySQL
Security: Splunk, iptables/UFW, Host Hardening, Incident Response, File Integrity Monitoring
Tools: Wireshark, Cisco Packet Tracer, GNS3, Bash, Git

Experience

Undergraduate Assistant, Networking Labs - Missouri State University August 2026 – Present

- Built and administer a Dell PowerEdge R730 running Proxmox, provisioning 15 Windows and Linux VMs supporting multiple ITC lab courses
- Stage lab environments each term by resetting and reconfiguring Cisco routers and switches, Palo Alto and FortiGate firewalls, and GNS3 servers
- Deployed a dedicated lab domain integrated with campus network authentication, preserving student access with university credentials

Resident Assistant, - Missouri State University August 2024 – May 2026

- Led and supported 47 residents through consistent engagement, community building, and social programming, resulting in a 70% resident reapplication rate
- De-escalated and managed 38 emergencies and high-stress incidents through calm decision-making and conflict resolution

Competitions

Linux Team Lead - Collegiate Cyber Defense Competition (CCDC) February 2025 - March 2026

- Placed 1st in Missouri and 7th in the Midwest Region
- Sustained 90%+ scored service uptime as team lead by directing three engineers across e-commerce, mail, and logging while detecting and remediating intrusions from professional penetration testers
- Kept a customer-facing OpenCart storefront and admin portal online through sustained attack by hardening Apache2, PHP, and MySQL and enforcing host-based firewall rules with iptables and UFW
- Completed 30+ timed business injects on deadline, spanning technical builds and service redundancy through regulatory gap analyses and executive briefings

AITCC - America's Innovate IT Collegiate Conference April 2026

- 2nd Place, IT Troubleshooting; Honorable Mention, Cyber Sentinels Challenge